Theme 3B Assessment Brief (50% weighting)

Assessment date or deadline (excluding extensions)

This date represents the general due date. If you have an extension, please check eVision for adjusted dates specific to you.

Written group project is due 12 noon on **27/11/2026** on Blackboard (worth 25%)

Individual reflections and AI-use statements should be included at the end of the report and signed by each group member. (worth 10%)

Assessed group presentations will take place on **3/12/2026**. (worth 15%)

Assessment task outline and requirements

This is a group assessment.

As a group you will choose a topic to research. This should be at 3rd year level in terms of difficulty, and should be a topic you have not previously studied at University. Your project must be based on scholarly material eg textbooks, peer reviewed journal articles. There is a list of suggested topics and initial reference materials provided via Blackboard, but you can also choose your own in discussion with the unit lecturer.

The deliverables will be a written project of up to 30 pages, and a 15 minute group presentation.

You can choose to add a 'wow factor' to make your project really stand out by also including some other aspect eg some computer code to implement some aspect of your topic, a poster or video to explain the topic to other university students or the general public. This is not a requirement.

At the end of the unit you will be asked to assess the contributions of all group members. This will be normalised to the average for your group.

Assessment type

Written project, oral presentation.

Assessment submission

Formative: You will submit a draft of your written work in Week 8 for feedback from the lecturer. You will do a practice presentation to a small group of peers and the lecturer on 28/11/2025 and receive formative feedback.

Summative: You will submit your written group project report, including any code or extra material (eg poster) via Blackboard. This will be marked and moderated by the lecturers.

You will present as a group to a small group of students and the lecturer, and they will provide feedback and assessment. Your group will then form the audience for other group presentations, where you should be prepared to ask a question and give feedback.

Academic integrity

Before starting this assessment, please read the University's information about academic integrity (http://www.bristol.ac.uk/students/support/academic-advice/academic-integrity/).

Generative AI Category

- **Category 3: Selective** – you may only use AI tools in the following ways: i) Exploring concepts: as an enhanced form of preliminary study aid. It should not be cited in your work and you will need to substantiate any ideas you apply through reference to peer-reviewed resources. ii) Initial Research: you can use AI as a mechanism for researching and exploring relevant literature and ideas. However, you should then read suggested sources rather than cite directly from the AI and the responsibility for accuracy remains with you. iii) Spelling and grammar checkers: you can use spelling and grammar checkers, although they should be used to correct rather than conduct substantial re-writes.

Marking criteria

Your report will be assessed by unit lecturers on the following criteria:

1. Use of evidence and sources: Does the report demonstrate ability to select and synthesise from a broad range of scholarly sources?
2. Content knowledge: Does the report demonstrate a high level of knowledge and understanding of content which would not be familiar to students previously?
3. Academic skills: Are accurate referencing and mathematical typesetting skills demonstrated? Is the report well-structured?
4. Explanation and Interpretation: Does the report demonstrate perception, critical insight and interpretation of ideas?
5. Communication: Does the report communicate well to the intended audience?
6. Teamwork: Is it apparent that the team has worked well together to produce a consistent report in a single voice?

Your presentation will be assessed by your peers and by the unit lecturers on the following criteria:

1. Content knowledge: Did the presenters demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the main theories and concepts of the topic covered?
2. Academic skills: Did the presenters demonstrate excellent presentation skills?
3. Explanation and Interpretation: Were the presenters able to provide perception, insight and interpretation of complex ideas?
4. Communication: Could the presenters communicate effectively and professionally to the audience in oral form?
5. Teamwork: Did the presentation demonstrate the ability for the team to work effectively together?

You will be asked to complete a short questionnaire rating the contributions of all group members to the project.

Learning and feedback connections

This task builds upon:

- Sessions on communicating technical mathematics, effective teamworking.
- Lecturer and peer feedback from draft report and practice presentations.

Learning and feedback from this assessment can be applied to:

- Future employment

Intended Learning Outcomes

- Communicate mathematics to different audiences.
- Constructively critique the contributions of others.
- Working effectively in groups.